

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1015

By Reneau

A RESOLUTION to commemorate the 250th anniversary of the founding of the United States of America.

WHEREAS, July 4, 2026, marks the 250th anniversary, or semiquincentennial, of the adoption of the Declaration of Independence by the Second Continental Congress in Philadelphia in 1776, signifying the founding of the United States of America; and

WHEREAS, the Declaration of Independence proclaimed timeless principles that remain central to the American experiment in self-government, including that all people are created equal, all people are endowed with certain unalienable rights, and governments derive their just powers from the consent of the governed; and

WHEREAS, the founding of the United States established a constitutional system grounded in liberty, federalism, separation of powers, and the rule of law—principles designed to protect individual freedom while ensuring accountable government; and

WHEREAS, throughout two and a half centuries, the American people have continued striving to form "a more perfect Union," advancing the promise of liberty through sacrifice, service, civic participation, and commitment to constitutional principles; and

WHEREAS, the State of Tennessee and its citizens have contributed immeasurably to the strength, character, defense, and prosperity of the United States through their leadership, innovation, military service, and dedication to community and country; and

WHEREAS, the semiquincentennial offers a historic opportunity for reflection, gratitude, education, and renewed commitment to the ideals upon which this nation was founded; and

WHEREAS, commemorative activities across this State can foster civic understanding, strengthen community bonds, inspire patriotism, and encourage thoughtful engagement with our shared history and future; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that this General Assembly commemorates the 250th anniversary of the founding of the United States of America.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that this General Assembly honors citizens, communities, civic organizations, educational institutions, and businesses throughout this State that participate in commemorative observances honoring our nation's history and celebrating the enduring principles of liberty, equality, and self-government.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that this General Assembly praises schools and educational institutions that provide strong civics education so that future generations understand the rights, responsibilities, and institutions of American constitutional government, recognizing that an informed citizenry is essential to the preservation of freedom.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the commemoration of the United States of America's 250th anniversary is not only a remembrance of the past but an opportunity to renew our collective commitment to upholding the founding ideals of this nation for generations yet to come.